THE AEO PLAYBOOK

How to write the page an AI quotes.

Answer engine optimisation is the on-page half of the job: one question, one page, the answer first.

EDITION 2026 EVERY NUMBER SOURCED CAL.COM/SOLVX-AI/15MIN

THE AEO PLAYBOOK

CONTENTS

01 AEO IN ONE LINE

02 ANATOMY OF AN ANSWER PAGE

03 QUESTIONS WORTH A PAGE

04 WHAT THE ENGINES THEMSELVES SAY

05 BEFORE YOU PUBLISH

Who it is for. Whoever writes or signs off the pages on your site.

Every number names its source; the full list is on the last page. Updated 7 October 2026.

01

AEO IN ONE LINE

- AEO makes a page the easiest source for an answer engine to quote.
- GEO is wider. It also covers what other sites say about you.
- SEO still gets the page crawled and indexed in the first place.

02

ANATOMY OF AN ANSWER PAGE

01 THE QUESTION IS THE TITLE

Use the words the patient or buyer uses. In our audit, 55% of the URLs Microsoft Copilot cited contained at least half of the words in the question.

02 THE ANSWER COMES FIRST

Two sentences that answer the question, before anything else on the page.

03 NUMBERS, WITH SOURCES

Adding statistics, quotations and citations lifted visibility by up to 40% in the original GEO study.

04 REAL QUESTIONS, VISIBLY ANSWERED

The follow-up questions people ask, answered on the page in plain text, not hidden in a tab.

05 A DATE AND A NAMED EXPERT

Pages AI assistants cite are 25.7% fresher than pages in classic results. Say who wrote or reviewed it and when.

06 ONE PAGE PER QUESTION

No mass-produced variants. Google counts pages spun out for every query variation as scaled content abuse.

03

QUESTIONS WORTH A PAGE

For a clinic, six kinds of question carry most of the bookings.

KIND	EXAMPLE
Best for	Best facelift surgeon in Scottsdale
Cost	How much do dental implants cost in Boca Raton?
Candidacy	Am I a candidate for LASIK?
Recovery	How long is recovery after Mohs surgery?
Comparison	Veneers or bonding: which lasts longer?
Risk	Is IVF safe after 40?

04

WHAT THE ENGINES THEMSELVES SAY

- Google: content that is not a commodity matters most. llms.txt, content chunking and special schema are not needed for its AI features.
- Google: one setting in Search Console now includes or excludes a site from AI Overviews and AI Mode. The default is include.
- Microsoft has published its own guidance on structuring content for inclusion in AI answers.

> *If a tactic is not in an engine's own documentation and no study has measured it, we do not sell it.*

05

BEFORE YOU PUBLISH

- [ ] The title is the question, in the asker's words.
- [ ] The first two sentences answer it.
- [ ] Every number links to where it came from.
- [ ] Follow-up questions are answered in visible text.
- [ ] There is a date and a named clinician or author.
- [ ] The page reads fully with JavaScript switched off.
- [ ] No other page on the site answers the same question.

NEXT STEP

FIFTEEN MINUTES. NO PITCH DECK.

Tell us the questions your patients or buyers ask. We will show you who the AI names for them.

BOOK A CALL

CAL.COM/SOLVX-AI/15MIN

SOURCES

1. Aggarwal et al.: GEO, Generative Engine Optimization (KDD 2024) — https://arxiv.org/abs/2311.09735
2. Ahrefs: AI assistants prefer to cite fresher content, 17M citations (Jul 2025) — https://ahrefs.com/blog/do-ai-assistants-prefer-to-cite-fresh-content/
3. Google Search Central: Optimizing for generative AI features (Jul 2026) — https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/ai-optimization-guide
4. Google Search Console Help: Search generative AI control (Aug 2026) — https://support.google.com/webmasters/answer/16908024
5. Microsoft Advertising: Optimizing content for inclusion in AI search answers (Oct 2025) — https://about.ads.microsoft.com/en/blog/post/october-2025/optimizing-your-content-for-inclusion-in-ai-search-answers
6. SolvX.AI: AI Answer Audit, 202 sources cited by Microsoft Copilot (Sep 2026, our own data)